

Human Anatomy & Physiology I

BIOL 2401 – Section 601

Department of Biological Sciences

Summer 2026

Instructor Information

Instructor: Dr. Priya Nandakumar

Email: pnandakumar@wcu.edu

Office Location: Life Sciences Building 108

Office Hours: MWF 8:00am – 9:30am or by appointment

Preferred Method of Contact: pnandakumar@wcu.edu or Campus LMS Inbox

When emailing, please include your course section number or class meeting time. My goal is to respond to all student communications within 24–48 hours on weekdays.

Teaching Assistant(s)

Marcus Tran | Lab TA | mbtran@wcu.edu

Olivia Schreiber | Lab TA | oschreiber@wcu.edu

Course Details

Meeting Days/Times/Locations

Start Date	End Date	Location	Meeting Day	Start Time	End Time
05/27/2026	09/15/2026	LSCI 0215	MWF	10:00 AM	10:50 AM
05/27/2026	09/15/2026	LSCI LAB 0040	T	02:00 PM	04:50 PM

Credit Hours: 4.00

Course Description

First course of a two-semester sequence covering structural and functional organization of the human body. Topics include cell biology, tissues, integumentary system, skeletal system, muscular system, and the nervous system. Includes a mandatory laboratory component with cadaveric specimens, anatomical models, and physiological experiments.

Required Texts and Materials

Textbook: Human Anatomy & Physiology

ISBN: 9780135206027

Authors: Marieb, Elaine N. / Hoehn, Katja N.

Publisher: Pearson

Edition: 11th

Additional Required Materials

- Dissection kit (purchase from bookstore)
- Lab coat (required for all lab sessions)
- Nitrile gloves (provided in lab)
- Colored pencils for lab diagrams

Course Learning Outcomes

Upon successful completion of this course, students will be able to:

1. CLO 1: Identify and describe the structural organization of the human body at all levels
2. CLO 2: Explain the physiological mechanisms of major organ systems covered in this course
3. CLO 3: Use correct anatomical terminology in oral and written communications
4. CLO 4: Perform laboratory procedures safely and accurately, and record observations
5. CLO 5: Connect structure to function at the cellular, tissue, and organ system levels
6. CLO 6: Interpret histological slides, anatomical models, and physiological data

Grading Policies & Grading Scale

Grade Breakdown

Activity	Weight	Details
Lecture Attendance & iClicker	5%	iClicker polls every lecture; 2 free absences
Lab Reports	15%	Weekly lab reports due before next lab; lowest dropped
Lab Practical 1	10%	Practical on cells, tissues, integument; July 7, 2026
Lab Practical 2	10%	Practical on skeletal & muscular systems; August 11, 2026
Midterm Exam 1	15%	Cells, Tissues, Integument; June 24, 2026
Midterm Exam 2	15%	Skeletal & Muscular Systems; July 22, 2026
Midterm Exam 3	10%	Nervous System I; August 19, 2026
Final Exam	20%	Comprehensive; September 11, 2026; 10:00 AM – 12:00 PM
Total	100%	

Grading Scale

A	A-	B+	B	B-	C+	C	C-	D+	D	D-	F
100–93	92–90	89–87	86–83	82–80	79–77	76–73	72–70	69–67	66–63	62–60	59–00

NOTE: Final grades are recorded as posted. No grade changes will be made after final grades are submitted.

Late Work Policy

- Late work is penalized 10% per day of delay.
- Assignments more than 5 days late will not be accepted.
- Lab/in-class work cannot be made up without a documented, university-approved excuse.

Important Exam Dates

Assessment	Date / Details
Lab Practical 1	Practical on cells, tissues, integument; July 7, 2026
Lab Practical 2	Practical on skeletal & muscular systems; August 11, 2026
Midterm Exam 1	Cells, Tissues, Integument; June 24, 2026
Midterm Exam 2	Skeletal & Muscular Systems; July 22, 2026
Midterm Exam 3	Nervous System I; August 19, 2026
Final Exam	Comprehensive; September 11, 2026; 10:00 AM – 12:00 PM

Course Schedule

Note: This schedule is subject to change. Any modifications will be announced via the LMS and/or email.

Week / Dates	Topic(s)	Assignments / Notes
Week 1 (May 27–30)	Intro to A&P; Anatomical Terminology	Lab 1: Intro & Safety; Lab Report 1
Week 2 (Jun 1–6)	Cell Structure & Function	Lab 2: Cell Microscopy; Lab Report 2
Week 3 (Jun 8–13)	Cell Membranes & Transport	Lab 3: Osmosis & Diffusion; Lab Report 3
Week 4 (Jun 15–20)	Tissues I: Epithelial & Connective	Lab 4: Histology Slides; Lab Report 4
Week 5 (Jun 22–27)	EXAM 1 – Jun 24 Tissues II; Integumentary System	Lab 5: Skin Models; Lab Report 5
Week 6 (Jun 29–Jul 4)	Bone Tissue & Skeleton Overview	Lab 6: Bones (No lab Jul 4)
Week 7 (Jul 6–11)	Axial Skeleton	LAB PRACTICAL 1 – Jul 7; Lab Report 6
Week 8 (Jul 13–18)	Appendicular Skeleton; Joints	Lab 7: Joint Movement; Lab Report 7

Week / Dates	Topic(s)	Assignments / Notes
Week 9 (Jul 20–25)	EXAM 2 – Jul 22 Muscle Tissue	Lab 8: Muscle Histology; Lab Report 8
Week 10 (Jul 27–Aug 1)	Muscles of the Body I	Lab 9: Cadaver Muscles I; Lab Report 9
Week 11 (Aug 3–8)	Muscles of the Body II	Lab 10: Cadaver Muscles II; Lab Report 10
Week 12 (Aug 10–15)	EXAM 3 – Aug 19 Nervous System I; Neurons	LAB PRACTICAL 2 – Aug 11; Lab Report 11
Week 13 (Aug 17–22)	Spinal Cord & Reflexes	Lab 11: Reflex Testing; Lab Report 12
Week 14 (Aug 24–29)	The Brain & Cranial Nerves	Lab 12: Brain Models
Week 15 (Aug 31–Sep 5)	Review & Integration	Cumulative Lab Report Review
Final Exam	September 11, 2026 10:00 AM – 12:00 PM	Comprehensive – All Topics

Course Policies

- Lab attendance is mandatory; missing more than 2 labs will result in automatic course failure.
- Proper PPE (lab coat and gloves) must be worn at all times in the laboratory.
- No food or drink is permitted in the laboratory at any time.
- Lab reports are due by 11:59 PM the night before the following lab session.
- Generative AI tools are NOT permitted on any assignments or exams in this course.
- Students must achieve a minimum score of 60% on each lab practical to pass the course.
- Exam make-ups are granted only for documented medical emergencies; request must be submitted within 24 hours of the missed exam.

Attendance Policy

Regular attendance is essential to success in this course. Students are expected to attend all scheduled class sessions and arrive on time. Attendance will be recorded each session.

Free Absences: Students are permitted two (2) free lecture absences and one (1) free lab absence per semester without penalty or documentation. Use these wisely.

Religious Observances: Notify the instructor in writing within the first two weeks of the semester. Arrangements for make-up work must be made in advance.

University Events: Provide official documentation from your university sponsor. Contact the instructor well in advance.

Exam Day Absences: Medical absences on exam days require documentation from a physician or the University Health Center and will be handled on a case-by-case basis.

Academic Integrity

Students are expected to maintain the highest standards of academic honesty. All submitted work must represent the student's own effort. Violations of the Academic Integrity Policy, including plagiarism, cheating, or unauthorized use of AI-generated content, will be referred to the Office of Academic Affairs and may result in a failing grade for the assignment or the course.

Generative AI Policy

The use of generative AI tools (including but not limited to ChatGPT, Google Gemini, Copilot, and DALL-E) is governed by the policy stated in the grading section above. Any violations will be treated as academic dishonesty. Students are encouraged to maintain time-stamped drafts and notes as evidence of independent work.

Disability Accommodations & Title IX

Disability Accommodations

Students who require academic accommodations must register with the Disability Resource Center (DRC) at drc.wcu.edu or by calling 828-227-2716. Once registered, students must submit an accommodation letter to the instructor at least one week before accommodations are needed. Accommodations are not retroactive.

Sexual Harassment & Title IX

All forms of sexual harassment, including sexual assault and dating violence, violate WCU policy and may violate federal law. Students may report concerns to the Title IX Coordinator at titleix@wcu.edu or 828-227-7021. Faculty are mandatory reporters.

Student Support Services

- Academic Success Center – Free tutoring and academic coaching: asc.wcu.edu
- Writing & Learning Commons – Writing support for all disciplines: writingcenter.wcu.edu
- Counseling & Psychological Services (CAPS) – Mental health support: 828-227-7469
- University Health Services – Medical and wellness support: 828-227-7640
- Dean of Students Office – Emergency support and student advocacy: 828-227-7234

Note: This syllabus is subject to change. The instructor reserves the right to modify the course schedule, assignments, and policies. Changes will be announced promptly via the LMS.